DESIGN CAPSULE · INDIA 2026–28

Design Capsule: Gen Z fusion

Kurtas with jeans and sneakers, sarees with trainers, oversized fits and co-ords: India's young shoppers mix it all.

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Mood and colour

Indigo 19-3864 TCX #2F3F7A	Sage 15-6414 TCX #9FAE8F
Rust 18-1248 TCX #B5522B	Ivory 11-0104 TCX #F3ECDC

Pantone TCX (cotton) codes are the nearest match to the screen colour; confirm against a physical Pantone book and lab dips before production.

Why? Gen Z makes up 40–45% of India's online shoppers and drove almost half of new orders in 2025. They discover styles on social video and buy fast, often through quick commerce.

What? Gen Z mixes ethnic and street: short kurtas over jeans, sarees with sneakers, jackets over lehengas, oversized tees, baggy denim, athleisure co-ords and gender-fluid boxy tailoring.

Who's showing it?

- **Gully Labs**: Everyday leather sneakers with Indian colour stories
- **Payal Pratap and Jubinav**: Embroidered jackets and sporty knitwear

Key pieces

The key pieces with reference photos, ready to brief into design.



Short kurtas with jeans

RISING

Hip-length kurtas worn with denim for everyday wear.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Rising	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Sarees with sneakers

RISING

Sarees worn with clean sneakers for day events.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Rising	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Jackets over lehengas

RISING

Cropped or denim jackets layered over lehengas.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Baggy and wide-leg jeans PEAKING

Relaxed, wide denim for comfort.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Peaking	Peaking	Fading	Fading

Festive 28
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Athleisure co-ord sets RISING

Matching jogger and sweat sets for hybrid campus days.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Varsity jackets RISING

Retro varsity jackets for campus wear.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Peaking	Fading	Fading

Festive 28
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Price guide (India)

KEY GARMENT	VALUE	MID	PREMIUM
Short kurta	₹499–999	₹1,200–2,500	₹5,000+
Baggy or wide-leg jeans	₹799–1,499	₹1,800–3,500	₹6,000+
Athleisure co-ord set	₹999–1,999	₹2,500–5,000	₹9,000+

Cost to make: Low. Simple shapes and fast fabrics keep costs low. Win on speed, size range and social-ready styling.

How to build the capsule

- Style every ethnic hero piece with sneakers and denim in imagery.
- Launch small, fast drops and watch social signals weekly.
- Make sure products are listed on quick-commerce and marketplace apps.

Range plan

Mix ethnic and streetwear: short kurtas with jeans, sarees with sneakers, jackets over lehengas. Keep prices accessible and use social content to show styling.

- **Hero pieces (about 20%):** the strongest expression of the story, at higher prices.
- **Core pieces (about 60%):** easy-to-wear styles in the capsule colours.
- **Add-ons (about 20%):** accessories and layers that increase basket size.

Selling it in different regions

In India, time the capsule to the festive or summer window it suits. For South Asian communities abroad, link it to local festival dates and weddings. For international customers new to Indian fashion, lead with easy pieces such as shirts, jackets and scarves, and explain the craft.

Common questions

What does Gen Z want from ethnic wear? Comfort, versatility and pieces that can be styled in many ways, at accessible prices.

Which channels work best? Social media, creators and quick-commerce and D2C sites with fast delivery.

Sources: Outlook Business on Gen Z and e-retail; Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports; Lakmé Fashion Week 2026 coverage.